

the education issue. The Democrats have generally been in the pocket of the teachers unions. President Obama has gone against his party's general stance and has embraced reform. I give him a lot of credit for doing that. The Race to the Top program was helpful in supporting charter schools in New York State by incentivizing states if they adopted pro-reform policies.



About a week after I interviewed Greenblatt, I sat in on his class in the Columbia Business School. On this particular day, Greenblatt had invited a guest lecturer and used the first half of the session to answer student questions. The premise of the Q&A format was that Greenblatt would answer the questions as he thought Warren Buffett would. Since Greenblatt's investment philosophy is so closely aligned to Buffett's, his students were continually confused whether he was answering a question as Buffett or as himself, although in many cases, it probably didn't make much difference. Below is a sampling of some of Greenblatt's comments in that class:

- My oldest son, who is a senior in college, is studying to be an opera singer. About half a year ago, he said to me, "Hey Dad, I'm probably going to be starving for the next five to six years, so maybe I should learn something about investing, too." I started teaching him in June. Stock prices have been crazy since then. He said everything I told him he would experience happened during his first five months he was watching the market. One of the stocks he picked at \$16 went down to \$9 dollars, then up to \$18, and then back to \$16 again. The business did not change at all during that period, yet the stock price changed significantly. Everybody says, "There are too many people looking at stocks; there are no more opportunities." There are plenty of opportunities.
- You are setting yourself up for failure if you invest differently than you want to in order to please investors.
- Manage your own account if you can. There is nothing like actually doing it and learning what it is like when you lose money and finding